KĀPMAN — Rules

Paper prototype v0.1 · core loop only · 1 player · ~45 min

*c. 790. Frisia lies under Frankish rule. You borrowed **100 silver** from the Count's reeve at Dorestad to buy a small trading ship. Pay him back in full, in Dorestad, by **day 60** — or lose the ship and your freedom.*

You need: this packet, **one d6**, a pencil and eraser, and a coin for your ship. Write everything in pencil.

Setup

1. Ship coin on **Dorestad**. Day marker on **day 1** (Tracker sheet).
2. Silver **30**. Debt **100**. Hull **8**, Crew **6**, Morale **5**. Hold empty (**6 lots**).
3. Spring card face up. Shuffle the 6 event cards and draw 1: it applies all Spring.

A turn = one port visit, then one voyage

In port (takes no days)

1. **Arrive.** Pay upkeep for the voyage just sailed: **1s per day**, plus **1s** for each crew above 6. Can't pay? Add the shortfall **+2** to your debt.
2. **New season?** If the day marker entered a new season since your last port: flip to that season card, add **interest** (10% of debt, round up), **erase all marks** on the Market sheet, discard the event and **draw a new one**.
3. **Market mood.** Roll d6 twice. 1st roll: that good **+3** here this visit. 2nd roll: that good **−3**. (Goods are numbered 1–6. Same number twice = no mood.)
4. **Do business**, any order: sell, buy, repair Hull (**3s**/point), hire Crew (**5s** each, max 8), pay debt (**Dorestad only**).
5. *Optional:* **wait a day** — +1 day, pay 1s, re-roll market mood.

Voyage

6. Choose a route from this port (Map). Leaving a Frankish port with swords? **Contraband check**.
7. Move the day marker forward by the route's days (+1 if Crew is under 4; +1 in Winter by sea).
8. **Encounter roll** (sea routes only): roll d6. Encounter if the roll is ≤ the route's danger: **coastal 1**, **open sea 1–2**. Summer and events can raise this. Then roll on the Encounter table.
9. Arrive at the new port → step 1.

Overland (Ribe–Hedeby): no encounter roll; pay 1s per lot carried for carts.

Encounter table (d6)

1–3	**Viking raiders** — fight (Battle sheet). *Winter: Storm instead.*
4	**Storm** — Hull −1 and +1 day. *Winter: Hull −2.*
5	**Frankish patrol** — carrying swords? Contraband check. Otherwise nothing.
6	**Frisian trader** — look at the top event card (put it back). You may swap 1 lot of cargo for 1 lot of any other good.

Prices

Price = base + your marks + season + event + mood. Minimum 1. You **buy and sell at the same price**, one lot at a time.

- After each lot you **buy**, mark **+1** on that good at that port.
- After each lot you **sell**, mark **−1**.
- Marks stay until the next season starts (markets recover).

So 3 lots bought at base 7 cost 7 + 8 + 9 = 24. Big single-good cargoes eat their own profit; mix goods.

Contraband: swords

- Buy only at **Dorestad** and **Quentovic**, **max 3 lots** per visit. Cannot be sold at Frankish ports.
- **Contraband check** every time you **leave or enter** a Frankish port (Dorestad, Medemblik, Quentovic) with swords aboard, and on a Patrol encounter: roll d6, **1–2 = caught**: all swords confiscated, **10s fine** (added to debt if you can't pay).
- Before rolling you may **bribe 5s**: then you're caught only on a 1.

Ship

- **Hull 0**: your ship sinks. Game over.
- **Crew under 4**: every voyage takes +1 day.
- **Morale** matters only in battle; it resets to 5 at any port.

Seasons & events

Days **1–15 Spring**, **16–30 Summer**, **31–45 Autumn**, **46–60 Winter**. Each season card lists its effects. One event is active at a time, for one season. Events are shuffled, not in date order: this is a prototype.

Debt

- Interest at the start of Summer, Autumn and Winter: **+10% of current debt** (round up). Paying early saves interest but ties up trading silver.
- Pay any amount, any time you're in Dorestad.
- **Due:** be in Dorestad with the debt cleared by the **end of day 60**. For missing it, see the Tracker sheet (Reeve's grace).

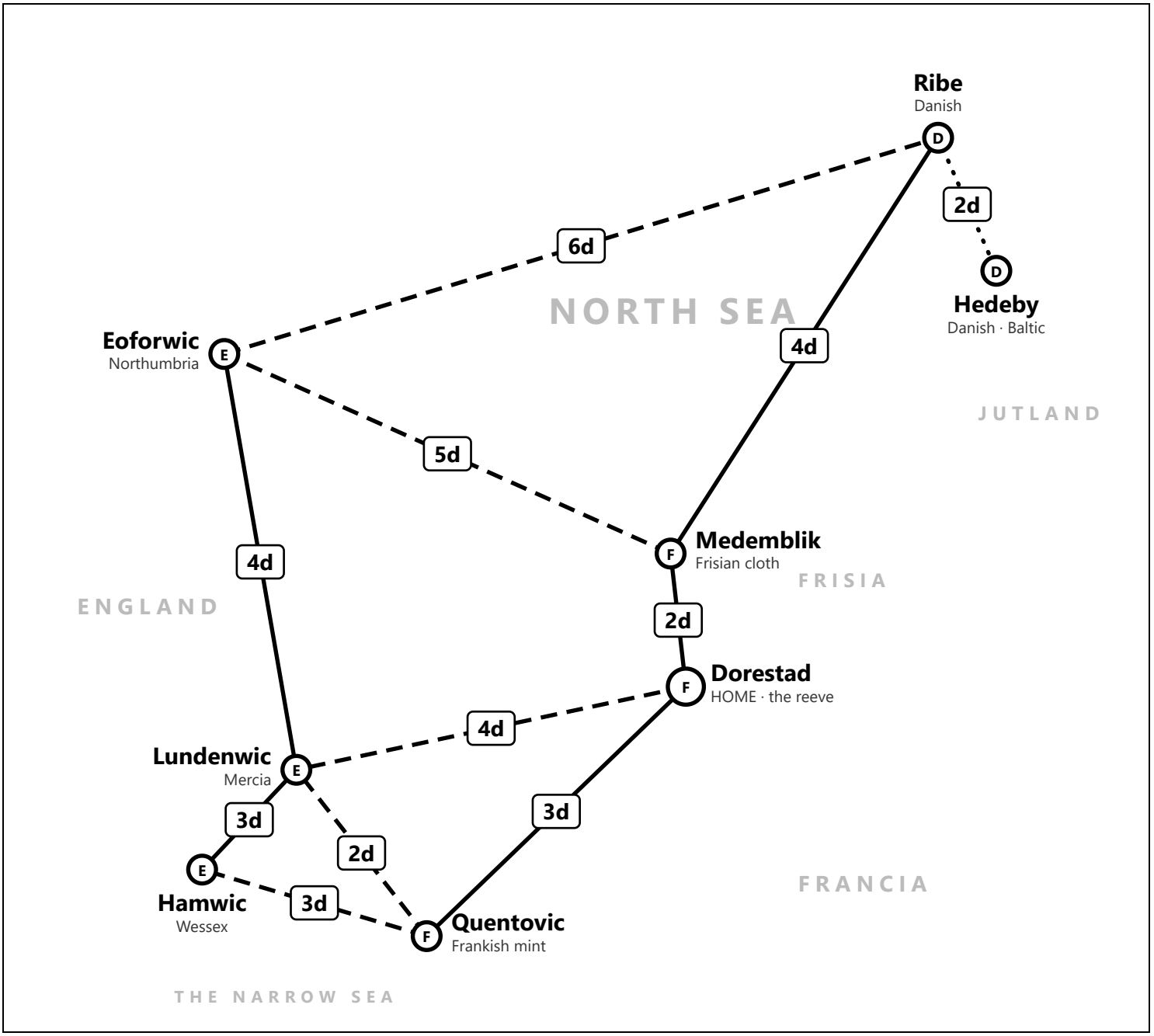
WIN — Debt cleared in Dorestad by day 60. **Score** = silver left (compare runs).

BITTER WIN — Cleared during the Reeve's grace (days 61–75).

LOSE — Deadline missed without grace, grace failed, ship sunk (Hull 0), or crew taken in battle (Crew 0).

KĀPMAN — Map

Route network · days are sailing days · not to scale



Route	Days	Type	Encounter on
Dorestad – Medemblik	2	coastal	1
Dorestad – Quentovic	3	coastal	1
Dorestad – Lundenwic	4	open sea	1–2
Medemblik – Ribe	4	coastal	1
Medemblik – Eoforwic	5	open sea	1–2
Quentovic – Lundenwic	2	open sea	1–2
Quentovic – Hamwic	3	open sea	1–2
Lundenwic – Hamwic	3	coastal	1
Lundenwic – Eoforwic	4	coastal	1
Eoforwic – Ribe	6	open sea	1–2
Ribe – Hedeby	2	land	—

Legend

Coastal: encounter on **1**

Open sea: encounter on **1–2**

Overland cart road: no encounters, 1s per lot

F Frankish port: contraband checks; swords can't be sold. **E** English. **D** Danish.

Summer: +1 danger on all sea routes. Winter: +1 day on all sea routes.

KĀPMAN — Market

Base price per lot, in silver · pencil your marks in the dashed box

Port	1. Grain staple	2. Cloth Frisian cloth	3. Wine Rhenish · seasonal	4. Furs luxury · winter demand	5. Amber luxury	6. Swords CONTRABAND
Dorestad Frankish	**6** marks	**10** marks	**8** marks	**20** marks	**24** marks	**12** buy only max 3 marks
Medemblik Frankish	**5** marks	**7** marks	**10** marks	**19** marks	**23** marks	
Quentovic Frankish	**5** marks	**10** marks	**9** marks	**20** marks	**25** marks	**13** buy only max 3 marks
Lundenwic English	**8** marks	**13** marks	**14** marks	**17** marks	**27** marks	**22** sell only marks
Hamwic English	**7** marks	**13** marks	**14** marks	**18** marks	**27** marks	**22** sell only marks
Eoforwic English	**9** marks	**15** marks	**17** marks	**15** marks	**26** marks	**24** sell only marks
Ribe Danish	**9** marks	**13** marks	**15** marks	**13** marks	**19** marks	**28** sell only marks
Hedeby Danish	**11** marks	**15** marks	**17** marks	**10** marks	**14** marks	**30** sell only marks

How to read a price

Price = base + marks + season + event + mood (minimum 1). Same price to buy or sell.

- **Marks:** each lot bought here **+1**, each lot sold here **−1**. Keep a running total in the dashed box. Erase all at each new season.
- **Mood** (on arrival): roll d6 twice. 1st = that good **+3**, 2nd = **−3**, this visit only. Goods are numbered 1–6 across the top.
- **Hold:** 6 lots total.

Season modifiers (quick reference)

Season	Price effect
Spring	Grain +2 everywhere
Summer	Furs −2 everywhere
Autumn	Grain −2 everywhere; Wine −3 at Frankish ports
Winter	Grain, Wine, Furs +4 at English & Danish ports

Hatched cell = not traded there. "buy only" = swords can be bought but not sold here (max 3 lots per visit).

KĀPMAN — Tracker

Days · debt · ship · hold

Days — cross off each day as it passes

Spring Grain +2	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
Summer +10% interest · danger +1	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30
Autumn +10% interest · harvest	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45
Winter +10% interest · storms	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	**60 DUE**
Reeve's grace only if granted	61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	**75 DUE**

The debt

Owed to the Count's reeve at Dorestad. Starts at **100s**. Interest **+10%** (round up) at the start of Summer, Autumn and Winter.

Due: in Dorestad, end of day 60.

Reeve's grace. If you're in Dorestad on day 60 but can't clear the debt, pay **at least half** of it now. The reeve takes the rest ×1.5 (round up), due in Dorestad by **day 75**. Play on under Winter rules. Clearing it = *bitter win*.

Otherwise (not in Dorestad by day 60, can't pay half, or miss day 75): the reeve seizes your ship and you work off the debt in bondage. **You lose.**

Ship

Hull 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

Crew 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 dashed = can hire

Morale 1 2 3 4 5 resets in port

Hold — 6 lots

#	Good	Paid	Bought at
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			

Purse & debt

Day	Port / note	Silver	Debt
1	Start: Dorestad	30	100

KĀPMAN — Battle

One enemy type: Viking raiders · one d6

Starting numbers

	Hull	Crew	Morale
You	current (8)	current (6)	5
Viking raiders	6	7	5

Range

Battles start at **FAR**. Once **CLOSE**, the range stays close. Some moves need CLOSE.

Round order

1. **You** pick one move and resolve it.
2. If the battle isn't over, the **raiders** roll d6 on their table.
3. Check the end conditions.

Morale

- A side that loses Crew in a round also loses **1 Morale** (once per round per side).
- Morale never goes above 5.

End of battle

Raiders' Morale 0, Crew ≤ 2, or Hull 0	They break off. **You win.** Loot: d6 × 3 silver (none if they sank).
Your Morale 0	Your crew surrenders. Raiders take **all cargo**. You sail on.
Your Crew 0	You're taken as slaves. **Game over.**
Your Hull 0	You sink. **Game over.**
Row Hard succeeds / Tribute paid	Battle ends. Voyage continues.

After battle, lost Crew and Hull stay lost until you hire and repair in port.

Your moves

Move	Range	Effect (roll d6)
Loose Arrows	any	4–5: raider Crew −1. 6: −2.
Spear Volley	CLOSE	3–4: raider Crew −1. 5–6: −2.
Board	CLOSE	**Boarding fight** (below). Win by 4+ and the raiders break at once.
Shield Wall	any	No roll. Until your next move: raider Crew damage −1 per hit, and **+2** to your boarding rolls.
Rally	any	1–2: Morale +1. 3–6: Morale +2.
Row Hard (flee)	any	FAR: escape on **3+**. CLOSE: escape on **5+**. −1 to the roll if Crew is under 4. Escape = voyage +1 day.
Pay Tribute	any	No roll. Pay **15s**, or hand over your **2 most valuable lots**. Battle ends.

Raider table (d6, every round)

1	**Jeer and circle**: nothing happens.
2	**Arrow storm**: your Crew −1.
3	**Close in**: range becomes CLOSE. Already close? Treat as 5.
4	**Ram**: range becomes CLOSE. Your Hull −2, their Hull −1.
5	**Spears**: at CLOSE your Crew −2. At FAR they close in instead.
6	**Board!** At CLOSE: boarding fight. At FAR: close in, and a war cry costs you 1 Morale.

Boarding fight

Each side rolls d6 + its current Crew (you roll twice, once per side). The higher total wins. The loser loses Crew equal to the difference (**max 3**). Tie: both lose 1 Crew.

Battle tracker — pencil in, erase after

	Hull	Crew	Morale	Range
You				☐ FAR ☐ CLOSE
Viking raiders	6	7	5	

KĀPMAN — Season cards

Cut along dashed lines · 4 cards · not shuffled, play in order

SEASON

Spring

Days 1–15

The sea opens. Granaries are nearly empty.

- **Grain +2** at every port.
- Encounters: normal danger.
- (Your first event is drawn at setup.)

Kāpman · season card · resolve on first arrival in port

SEASON

Summer

Days 16–30

Raiding season. The dragon-ships are out.

- On arrival: **interest +10%** of debt.
- **Danger +1** on every sea route (coastal 1–2, open 1–3).
- **Furs −2** at every port.

Kāpman · season card · resolve on first arrival in port

SEASON

Autumn

Days 31–45

Harvest and vintage. Barns full, casks new.

- On arrival: **interest +10%** of debt.
- **Grain −2** at every port.
- **Wine −3** at Frankish ports (Dorestad, Medemblik, Quentovic).

Kāpman · season card · resolve on first arrival in port

SEASON

Winter

Days 46–60 · DEBT DUE DAY 60

Storms and short days. The raiders have gone home to their halls, but the sea is cruel.

- On arrival: **interest +10%** of debt.
- Every sea voyage **+1 day**.
- Open-sea danger **1–3**. Raider results become **Storms**; a Storm costs Hull −2.
- Scarcity: **Grain, Wine, Furs +4** at English & Danish ports.

Kāpman · season card · resolve on first arrival in port

KĀPMAN — Event cards

Cut along dashed lines · 6 cards · shuffle; draw 1 each season

EVENT

Charlemagne's Embargo

c. 790

Charles quarrels with King Offa of Mercia and closes his ports to English ships.

This season:

- **CLOSED:** Dorestad–Lundenwic, Quentovic–Lundenwic, Quentovic–Hamwic.
- **Cloth +4** at Lundenwic and Hamwic.

Kāpman · event card · lasts one season

EVENT

Famine in Francia

792–793

The harvest fails across the Frankish realm. Bread is dear from the Rhine to the Canche.

This season:

- **Grain +5** at Dorestad, Medemblik and Quentovic.

Kāpman · event card · lasts one season

EVENT

Lindisfarne

8 June 793

Northmen fall on the holy island. Every English coast fears the sea.

This season:

- **CLOSED:** Eoforwic–Ribe.
- **Danger +1** on Lundenwic–Eoforwic and Medemblik–Eoforwic.
- **Swords +5** at English ports.

Kāpman · event card · lasts one season

EVENT

Capitulary of Thionville

805

Charlemagne forbids merchants to carry weapons and mail beyond the frontier.

This season:

- Contraband checks catch you on **1–3** (bribe: 1–2).
- **Swords +4** at Ribe and Hedeby.

Kāpman · event card · lasts one season

EVENT

Godfred Moves the Merchants

808

King Godfred razes Reric and moves its traders to Hedeby. The market swells.

This season:

- At Hedeby: **Furs and Amber −3**.
- At Hedeby: **Cloth and Wine +3**.

Kāpman · event card · lasts one season

EVENT

Dorestad Burns

834

Danes sail up the Rhine and burn the lower town.

This season:

- **If you're at Dorestad now:** roll d6. 1–3: lose 1 lot of your choice.
- **Grain, Cloth, Wine +4** at Dorestad.
- **Danger +1** on all routes to or from Dorestad.

Kāpman · event card · lasts one season

An event applies until the next season starts, then it's discarded. You'll see 4 of the 6 each run. Dates are real but shuffled: in this prototype, history happens out of order.

KĀPMAN — Playtest log

This is for tuning: write down what felt wrong

Run results

Run	Result	Day ended	Silver left	Battles (won/fled/paid/lost)	Sword runs (ok/caught)	Minutes
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						

After each run, ask:

1. Did clearing the debt feel **earned**, or lucky or trivial? At what day did you know you'd make it (or not)?
2. Was there a real choice at each port, or one obvious best route?
3. Did you ever **fear** a voyage? Which route, and why?
4. Did you run swords? Was the risk worth it, or never worth it?
5. Battles: did you ever pick a move besides the best one? Did you flee or pay tribute?
6. Did any season or event change your plans?
7. Where was bookkeeping tedious? (That tells the Godot build what to automate or cut.)
8. Did you pay the debt early to save interest, or hold silver for trading?

Tuning knobs (v0.1 values)

Knob	v0.1	Try
Starting silver / debt	30 / 100	
Interest per season	10%	
Deadline / grace	day 60 / 75	
Hold size (lots)	6	
Price shift per lot traded	1	
Market mood swing	±3	
Upkeep per day	1s	
Encounter: coastal / open	1 / 1–2	
Raiders on encounter table	1–3	
Raider Hull/Crew/Morale	6 / 7 / 5	
Sword caught on / fine	1–2 / 10s	
Sword buy limit per visit	3	
Tribute	15s	

Notes